

AI Fundamentals

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Collaborate with AI

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Module 6

Use AI responsibly

Responsible AI practice

Video • 4 min

Wait, what should you do if you get a bad response from Gemini?

Video • 40 sec

Responsible AI best practices

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Responsible AI best practices

AI can be a powerful collaborator, but it doesn't have your real-world experience, context, or common sense. Maintaining a human-in-the-loop approach enables you to catch issues early and deliver work you can stand behind. It's not about memorizing a rigid set of rules. Instead, it's about building the judgment that enables you to use AI responsibly.

Take steps to protect sensitive information

Keeping information secure means safeguarding and preventing unauthorized access to personal information and private data.

It's important to know what data is collected and how it might be used before you accept terms of service for a website or an app. Avoid entering confidential or sensitive information into publicly available tools. Before submitting any prompt, it's a good idea to pause and ask yourself, "Am I including data in my prompt that someone else might expect me to keep private?"

As the user, there are measures you can take to help protect your own privacy and security, as well as that of your organization, coworkers, and business partners.

Here are a few practical ways to protect confidential information:

- **Use generic placeholders** when referring to people, projects, or places
- **Frame prompts** around the task you need done, not the people involved
- **Input only relevant content** needed to complete the task, rather than entire documents
- **Clear AI's memory** to give it a clean slate, help protect privacy, and prevent bias from old prompts

Check out [how to manage your privacy settings and your conversation history in Gemini](#).

Understand regulatory and compliance boundaries

Some tasks can carry legal or compliance requirements that can limit or prohibit AI use, even when the technology seems capable.

Industries such as finance, legal, and healthcare operate under strict regulations about how decisions are made, how data is handled, and what must be documented. AI is not a substitute for a qualified professional, sound judgment, and accountability.

Before using AI for any work that might touch on regulated areas, ask yourself:

- **Does this task have regulatory requirements?** Managing medical records, financial reporting, legal documents, and compliance filings may have specific handling requirements. Consult your employer's policies or a qualified professional to determine the limitations of using AI in these instances.
- **Are there licensing or credential requirements?** Some work must be performed or verified by licensed professionals. AI is not a substitute for advice from a qualified professional.
- **Who is responsible?** People are responsible for the inputs and outputs of AI tools and should ensure they have the appropriate oversight when using AI tools.

Consult your organization's compliance team, legal counsel, or regulatory experts and policies before using AI in these contexts.

Build accountability into your process

Creating a trail that shows how you used AI responsibly can help stakeholders and others follow your process. This isn't stop work meant to slow down your process. It's professional integrity.

Here are some steps you can take to demonstrate how you've used AI in your work:

- **Track your sources.** Distinguish between AI-generated content and your own contributions so you can verify or explain your work later.
- **Make your process auditable.** If someone asks "How did you reach this conclusion?" you should be able to walk them through which parts involved AI and how you validated them.
- **Document your verification steps.** Keep notes on how you checked AI's work, especially for important deliverables.

Use the ACT checklist

Make sure you follow the **ACT** checklist every time you use AI. It's your cheat sheet for using AI responsibly.

A stands for "Ask yourself"

- **Is AI right for this task?** Don't rely on AI for medical, legal, financial, or other professional advice. Always consult a qualified human professional.
- **Is this data safe to use?** Avoid inputting sensitive, confidential, personal, or proprietary data into a public AI tool, like internal company data or customers' personally identifiable information.
- **Am I following the rules?** Always check your employer's policies on using AI at work and make sure you're using an approved tool, like an enterprise tool versus a public one.

C stands for "Check before you use the output"

- **For accuracy:** Make sure you independently verify all information presented as fact (names, statistics, quotes, etc.) and watch out for subtle hallucinations and errors.
- **For bias and objectivity:** Always evaluate the output to make sure it does not contain unfair biases or present a one-sided argument.
- **For appropriateness:** Assess whether the tone and style of the output is right for your intended audience and purpose, like a company social media post versus a casual email.
- **For originality and judgment:** Edit, refine, and add your own expertise to improve the AI output. If you receive an output that does not meet your need, iterate on your prompt to get better results.

T stands for "Tell people when you use AI"

- **Be transparent:** Clearly and appropriately disclose where and when AI was used to help generate content.
- **Be compliant:** Always follow your company's specific guidelines on AI disclosure, and never input any sensitive information into a public-facing AI tool.

Responsible AI use isn't just about avoiding mistakes. It's about leading with professional integrity. Reference this reading whenever you need a refresher on responsibly applying AI to your work.

Mark as completed